



Course Name

NIGERIAN PEOPLE'S & CULTURE

Topic: Nigerian People's & Culture

WEEK 7

IN SUMMARY

This week, you learned about the fundamental concepts of democracy and the rule of law, as well as the essential characteristics of a democratic society. Democracy, characterised by the government of the people, by the people, and for the people, is considered the most legitimate form of governance in modern times. It emphasises free and egalitarian societies built around strong institutions rather than individuals or groups. The rule of law ensures that a nation is governed by laws rather than arbitrary decisions by government officials. Key principles of the rule of law include the supremacy of law, equality before the law, and the protection of individual rights through the courts.

In Nigeria, democracy is a work in progress, with the country classified as a hybrid state due to its challenges in meeting the criteria of a full democracy. Human rights, a crucial aspect of democracy, are enshrined in the constitution, but there are ongoing issues of abuse, including extrajudicial killings, limitations on freedom of expression, child marriage, and domestic violence. The National Human Rights Commission reported a high number of rights violations in 2021, indicating the need for improved protection and enforcement of human rights in Nigeria.

BULLET POINT SUMMARY

- Democracy is a popular and enduring form of government that empowers the people through elections.
- The rule of law is based on principles like law supremacy, equality, and protection of individual rights.
- Nigeria is considered a hybrid state on the Democracy Index.
- Human rights abuses in Nigeria include extrajudicial killings, restrictions on freedom of expression, child marriage, and domestic violence.
- The National Human Rights Commission received a high number of complaints in 2021.
- Improvements are needed to protect and enforce human rights in Nigeria.

Democracy



CASE STUDY

Title: Human Rights Abuses in Nigeria

Introduction: This case study explores human rights abuses in Nigeria, focusing on the violations and challenges faced in protecting these rights.

Objective: To understand the extent of human rights abuses in Nigeria, the legal framework, and the challenges in addressing them.

Methods: This study uses information from the 1999 Constitution, the African Charter on Human and People's Rights, and data from the National Human Rights Commission. It highlights common human rights abuses in Nigeria, including extrajudicial killings, freedom of expression restrictions, child marriage, and domestic violence, while also discussing efforts and challenges in addressing these issues. It concludes by emphasising the importance of enforcing human rights and the rule of law for a just and democratic society.

QUESTIONS TO PONDER

- Imagine a world where people have no say in how they are governed and are not treated equally under the law. How would that impact society?
- How can you visualise the concept of democracy in action, where citizens actively participate in governing their country?
- Can you imagine a society where the rule of law is absent and government officials make arbitrary decisions without legal constraints? What might be the consequences of such a scenario?



SKILLS AND COMPETENCIES YOU HAVE ACQUIRED AFTER THIS LESSON

- Critical thinking
- Knowledge of political systems
- Understanding of human rights
- Analytical skills
- Cultural awareness

PERSONAL REFLECTION

How can I, as an individual, contribute to promoting and protecting human rights in my own community and society, considering the lessons on human rights abuses in Nigeria and the principles of democracy and the rule of law?